

Yikuan Li

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Research Interests

Pre-training and post-training of large language models, with a focus on optimizers, parameter-efficient fine-tuning (PEFT), and efficient training.

Education

University of Warwick Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2027
BSc Mathematics and Statistics Coventry, UK

- **Year 1:** 88.8/100 (First Class; Top 10 of 269). **Year 2:** 88.5/100 (First Class; Top 10).
- **Academic Excellence Prize** in both Year 1 and Year 2.
- **Selected coursework:** Optimization (MSc-level), Probability, Mathematical Statistics, Stochastic Processes, Multilinear Algebra, Analysis I–III, Multivariable Analysis, Metric Spaces, ODE & PDE, Algorithms, Java Programming.

Publications & Preprints

Are Parameter-Efficient Fine-tuning Methods Really Different?

Yikuan Li, Pinyan Lu, Fanghui Liu.

Preprint.

Research Experience

Parameter-efficient fine-tuning Jun. 2025 – Present
Research with Prof. Fanghui Liu

- Study PEFT designs for large language models, including LoRA, OFT, HRA, and related methods.
- Run controlled fine-tuning experiments on GPU clusters and compare training dynamics.
- This research led to the preprint *Are Parameter-Efficient Fine-tuning Methods Really Different?*

Post-training of large language models Jun. 2026 – Present
Research with Dr. Paris Giampouras

Department of Computer Science, University of Warwick

Self-Studied Online Coursework

Completed lectures and assignments for **Stanford** CS229 (Machine Learning), CS231N (Computer Vision), and CS224N (NLP with Deep Learning); **MIT** 18.S096 (Matrix Calculus for ML and Beyond) and 6.S184 (Flow Matching and Diffusion Models).

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, SQL, MATLAB, R, Java

ML/DL: NumPy, PyTorch, Transformers, PEFT; Slurm for GPU workloads

Tools: $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git, Linux/Bash, Claude Code, Codex, Cursor

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native), Cantonese (fluent)

Additional Experience

Flywheel May 2024 – Aug. 2024
Data Analyst Intern Hangzhou, China

- Developed time-series pipelines using Prophet, SARIMA, and LSTM to forecast gross merchandise value (GMV) around major promotional events.
- Automated data consolidation and reporting in Python, reducing manual processing time by approximately 50%.